XIAMEN UNIVERSITY MALAYSIA
厦門大學馬來西亞分校

XMUM 26/12 ORIENTATION



Game Master Handbook

How to run your station with the Game Master account, step by step.

2 Days | **3** Steps per Game | **1** Phone at Your Station

FOR GAME MASTERS ONLY / NOVEMBER 2026

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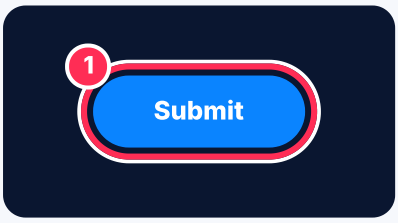
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How to Read This Handbook



A red circle shows exactly where to tap or what to look at.

The number on the circle is the same as the step number beside the picture. Do the steps in order.

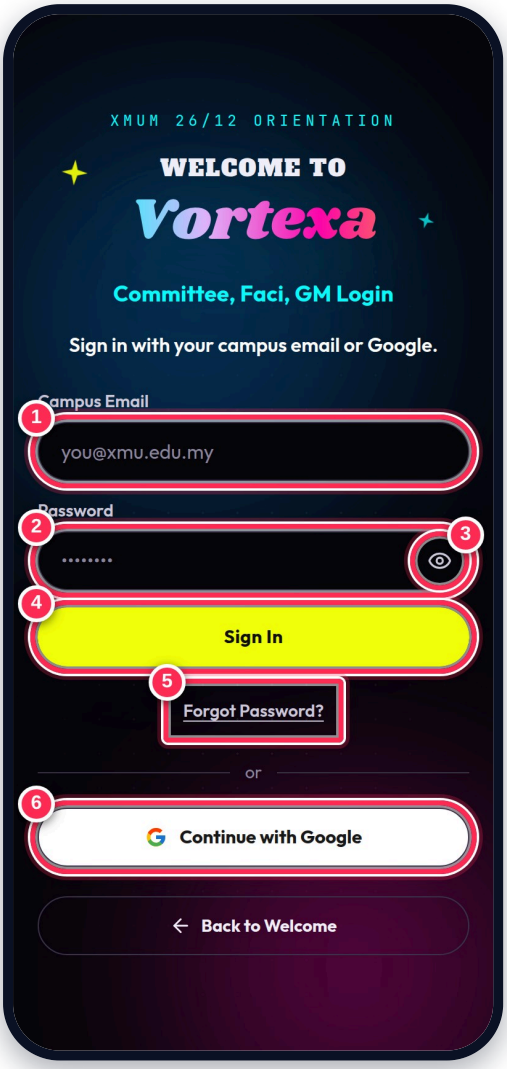
All pictures use **sample data**. Your screen shows your own name and your own stations. Token amounts come from Admin's rules and can differ from the pictures.

Your Job in One Minute

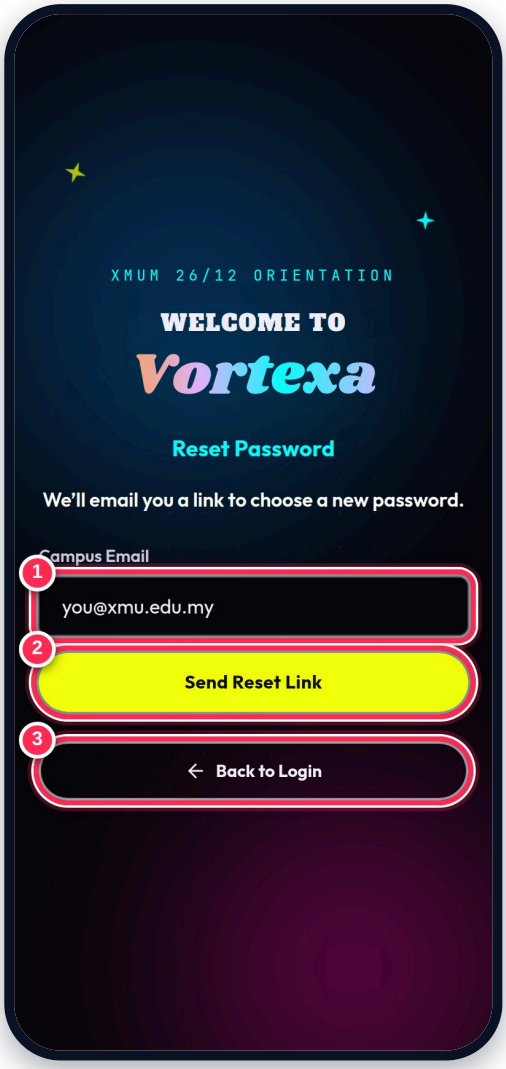
DAY 1	Groups play a mini-game at your station. **Pick** the group (or two groups), **Play**, then **Give** tokens: *Win* or *Participation*.
DAY 2	A group pays an entry fee to try your challenge. **Check** the group, **Play**, then **Submit** *Success* or *Failed*. A success also gives a puzzle piece.
ALWAYS	Use **one phone** at your station. Keep the page open. Wait for the confirmation message after you submit.
IF YOU SLIP	On Day 1, **Undo My Last Transaction** works for a few minutes. For anything else, tell Admin.

1.1 Sign In

Open the Vortexa website on your phone and log in with the account the organisers gave you.



Login page



Reset Password page (1.2)

1. Type your **Campus Email** (`you@xmu.edu.my`).
2. Type your **Password**.
3. Tap the **eye** to show the password and check for typing mistakes.
4. Tap **Sign In**. You land on your Home page.
5. Forgot your password? Tap **Forgot Password?** (see 1.2).
6. Or tap **Continue with Google** if you use your Google account.

1.2 Forgot Password

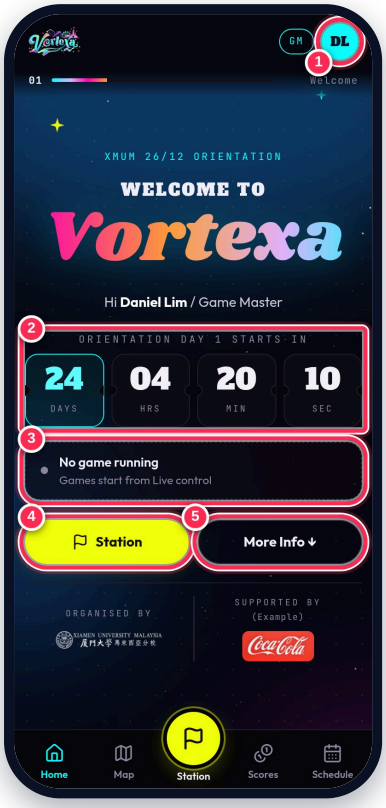
1. Type your **Campus Email**.
2. Tap **Send Reset Link**. Open the email and follow the link to choose a new password.
3. Tap **Back to Login** to return to the login page.

GOOD TO KNOW

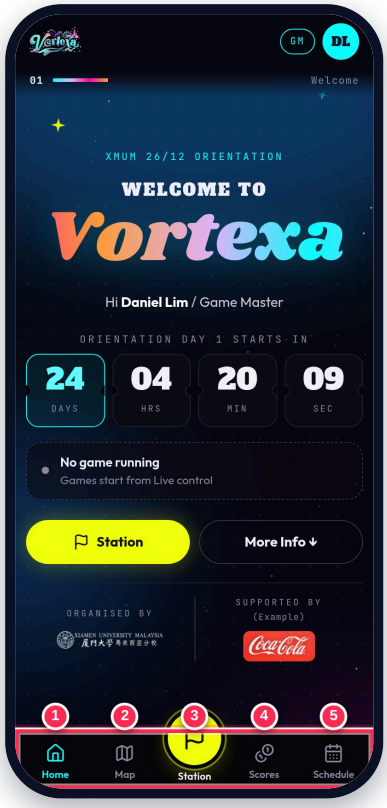
Admin creates your account and gives you your stations. If you sign in with Google for the first time, an Admin may need to approve you first. This handbook covers the **Game Master** account, not Guardian GM.

1.3 Find Your Way Around

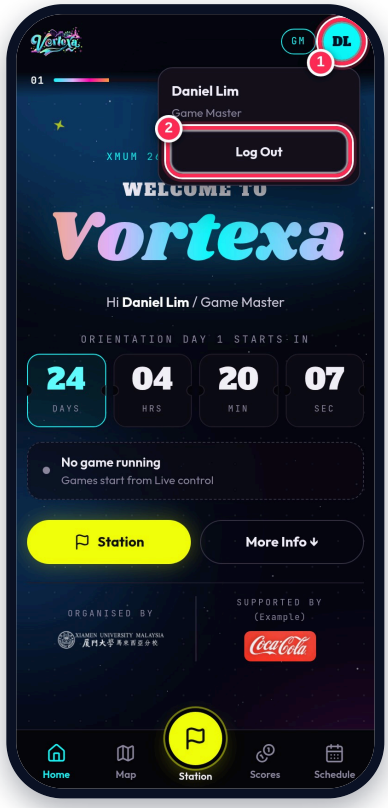
Every page has the same tab bar at the bottom. Your **Station** button is the big yellow one in the middle.



Home page



The tab bar



The account menu

1. **Profile button** with your initials. Tap it for the account menu.
2. **Countdown** to the next part of the event. When a game runs it shows the live phase and timer.
3. **No game running**: Admin starts the games from Live control.
4. **Station** opens your Station Panel (Part 3).
5. **More Info** scrolls down to the scores and tools.

1. **Home**.
2. **Map**: stations and group locations.
3. **Station**: the yellow button. Your games.
4. **Scores**: live tokens and puzzle counts.
5. **Schedule**: the programme.

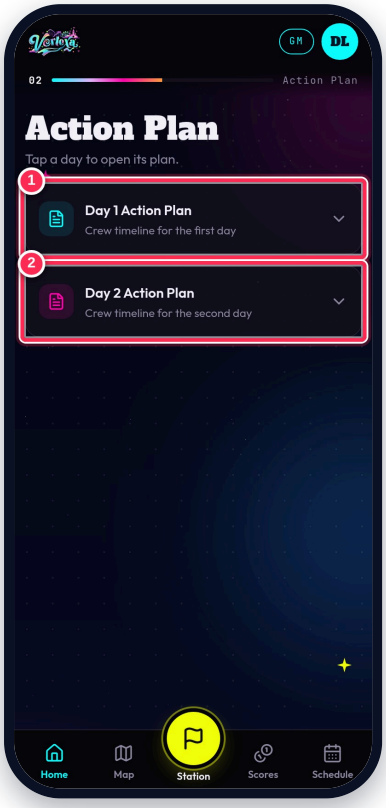
1. Tap your **profile button**. It shows your name and role.
2. **Log Out** signs you out of this phone.

TIP

Home is one long page. Swipe up to move through it: Welcome, Action Plan, Tokens and Event Tools. The small bar at the top shows where you are.

2.1 Home: Action Plan, Tokens and Tools

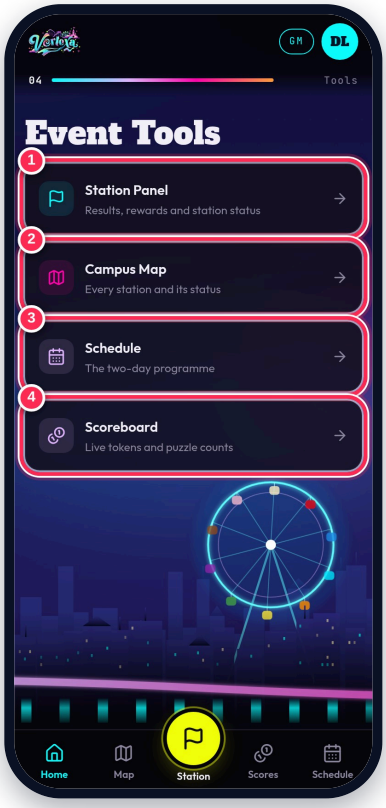
Swipe up on Home to reach three more sections. They are for looking things up. The games are run from the Station Panel.



Home / Action Plan



Home / Tokens



Home / Event Tools

Action Plan

1. **Day 1 Action Plan**: tap to open the crew timeline for Day 1.
2. **Day 2 Action Plan**: tap to open the crew timeline for Day 2. Tap **Open Full Size** to zoom in.

Tokens

1. **Full scoreboard** opens the Scores page (Part 4).
2. One row per group with its tokens. Rows update on their own.

Event Tools

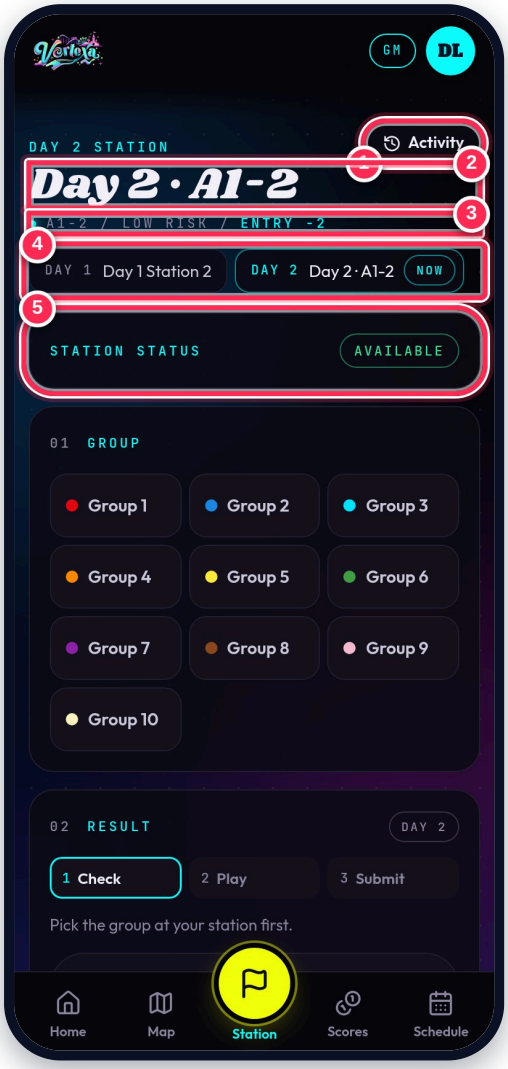
1. **Station Panel**: results, rewards and station status.
2. **Campus Map**: every station and its status.
3. **Schedule**: the two-day programme.
4. **Scoreboard**: live tokens and puzzle counts.

GOOD TO KNOW

Home has no blind box for Game Masters. You only run your station.

3.0 The Station Panel

This is where you run your games. Open it with the yellow **Station** button. Your station can be different on Day 1 and Day 2.



Station Panel (Day 2 station)

1. **Activity**: the token changes you made (3.5).
2. **Station name** and the day. The line under it shows the station code, and on Day 2 the risk level and the **entry fee**.
3. **Your stations**: your Day 1 and Day 2 stations. The one marked **NOW** is the one you can run.
4. **Station Status**: Available, In Progress or Closed (3.4).

The Cards, Top to Bottom

Station Status	Shows the state of your station.
01 Group	Tap the group that is at your station.
02 Result	The three steps of a game and the buttons to run it.

Two Days, Two Flows

Day 1
Pick, Play, Give

→

Day 2
Check, Play, Submit

GOOD TO KNOW
The station you can run follows the **game phases** started in Live control, not the calendar. When Day 2 starts, **NOW** moves to your Day 2 station by itself. You do not need to reload.

IMPORTANT
You can only run the station marked **NOW**. If it says *No Station Yet*, ask Admin to assign your station.

3.1 Day 1 Games: Pick and Start

On Day 1 a group plays a mini-game at your station. You tell the website who played and how they did.

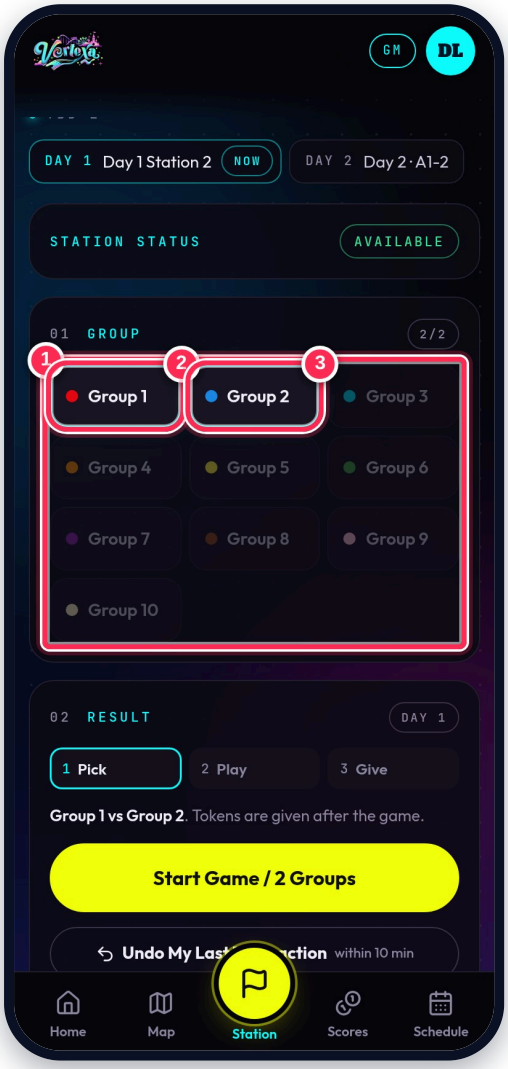
1 Pick
Choose the group or groups

→

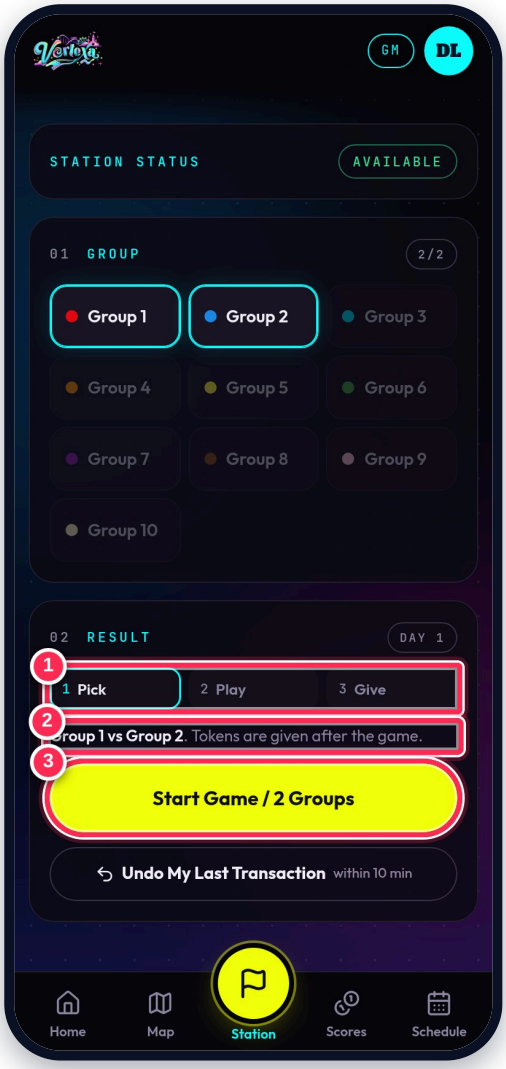
2 Play
Start the game

→

3 Give
Win or Participation



01 Group: Pick



02 Result: Start the game

1. The **group buttons**. Tap the group at your station. For a **head-to-head**, tap two groups. The counter at the top right shows *1/2* or *2/2*.
2. The first group you picked.
3. The second group. Tap a picked group again to remove it.

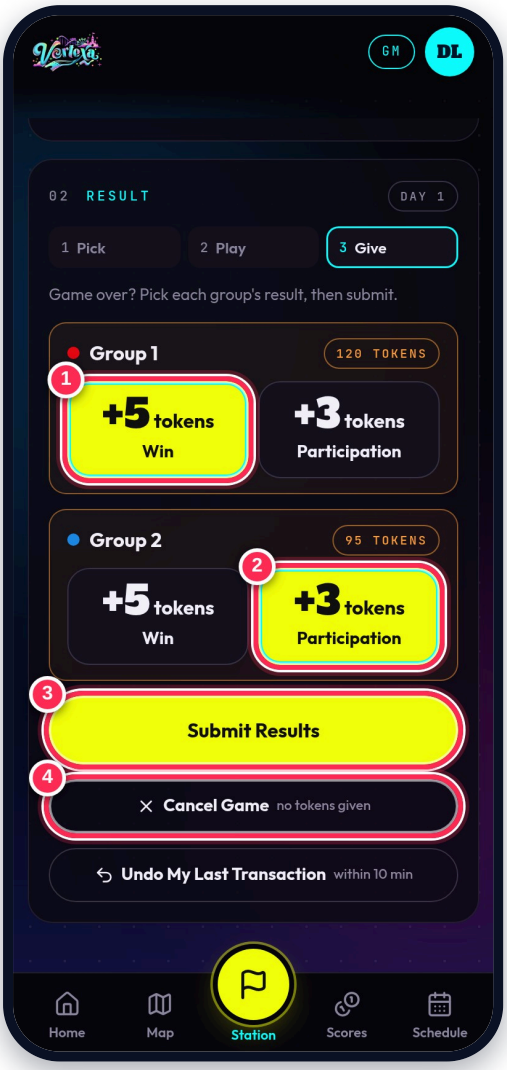
1. The **step bar**. You are on step **1 Pick**.
2. The text names the group or groups (for example *Group 1 vs Group 2*). **Tokens are given after the game.**
3. Tap **Start Game** (or **Start Game / 2 Groups**).

GOOD TO KNOW

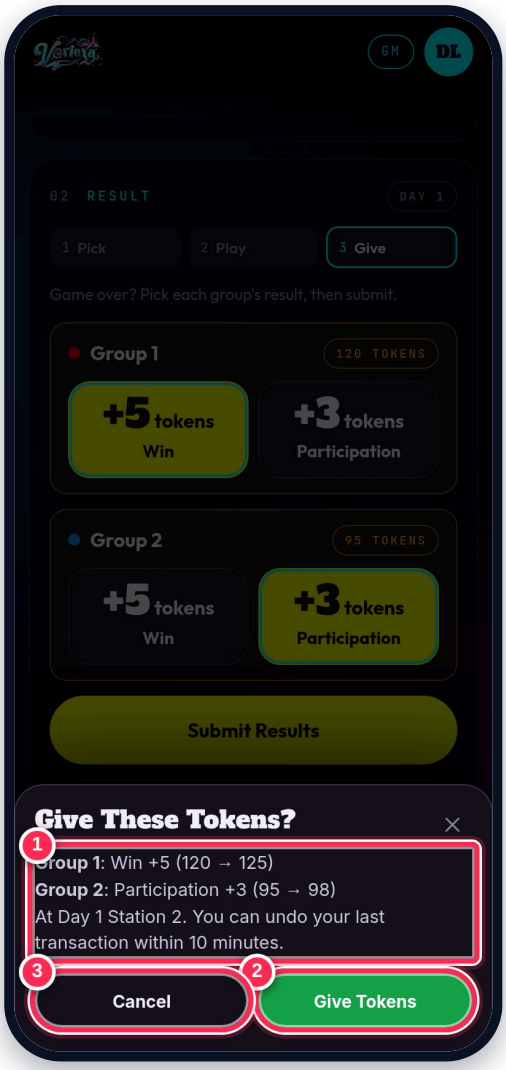
Start Game sets your station to **In Progress** and checks the groups in at your station, so the maps show who is playing. Nothing is given yet.

3.1 Day 1 Games: Play and Give

When the game is over, choose each group's result and give the tokens.



Step 3: Give



Confirm sheet: Give These Tokens?

1. **Win** for the winning group. The amount shown is the reward.
2. **Participation** for a group that took part but did not win.
3. Tap **Submit Result** (or **Submit Results** for two groups). It stays grey until every group has a result.
4. **Cancel Game** ends the game without giving any tokens.

1. Read each group's result, the tokens added and the new balance.
2. **Give Tokens** sends it. Tap **Cancel** to go back and change a result.

IMPORTANT

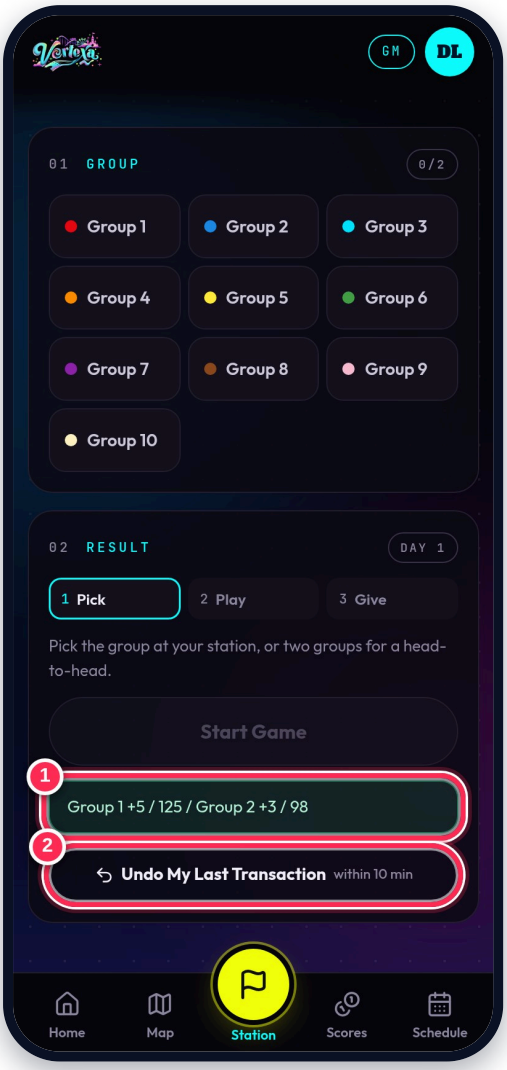
The **amounts** (Win and Participation) are set by Admin in the token rules. You cannot choose them. In a head-to-head, **both groups can win**.

TIP

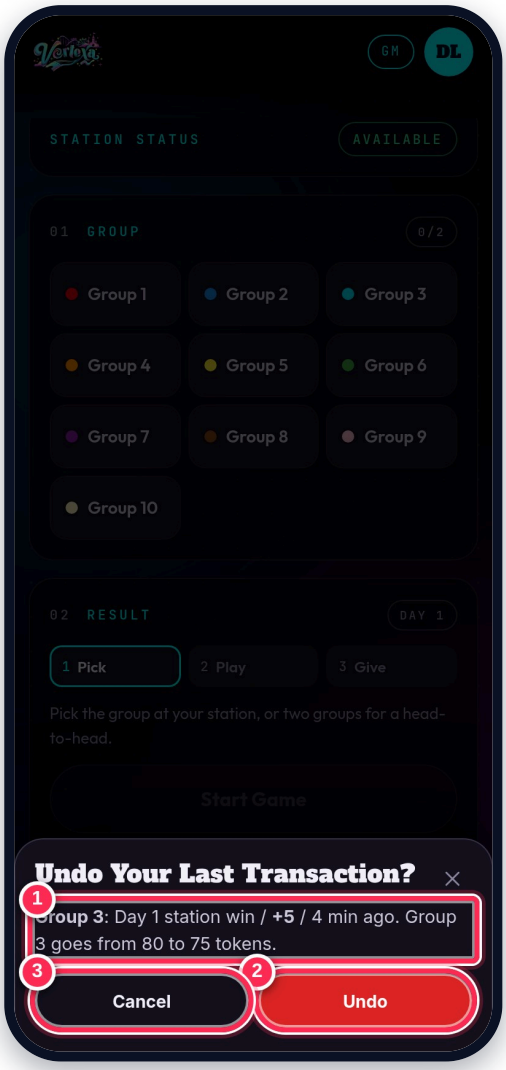
Check the group names on the sheet before you tap Give Tokens. That is the moment to catch a mistake.

3.1 Day 1 Games: After Giving

Check the message, and know how to undo a mistake.



After Give Tokens



Undo Your Last Transaction?

1. The green message lists each group, the tokens added and the new balance, for example *Group 1 +5 / 125*.
2. **Undo My Last Transaction**. It is available for a few minutes (the button shows how many).

GOOD TO KNOW

Your station goes back to **Available** and the groups are checked out, ready for the next game.

1. The sheet shows **what will be reversed**: the group, the reason, the tokens and how long ago.
2. **Undo** takes those tokens back. **Cancel** keeps everything as it is.

IMPORTANT

Undo reverses **only your last transaction**, and only inside the time window Admin set (10 minutes by default). It is for **Day 1** rewards. After the window, ask Admin.

3.2 Day 2 Games: Check

On Day 2 a group pays an **entry fee** to try your challenge. Before you start, the website checks that everything is in order.

1 Check
Pick the group, read the checks

→

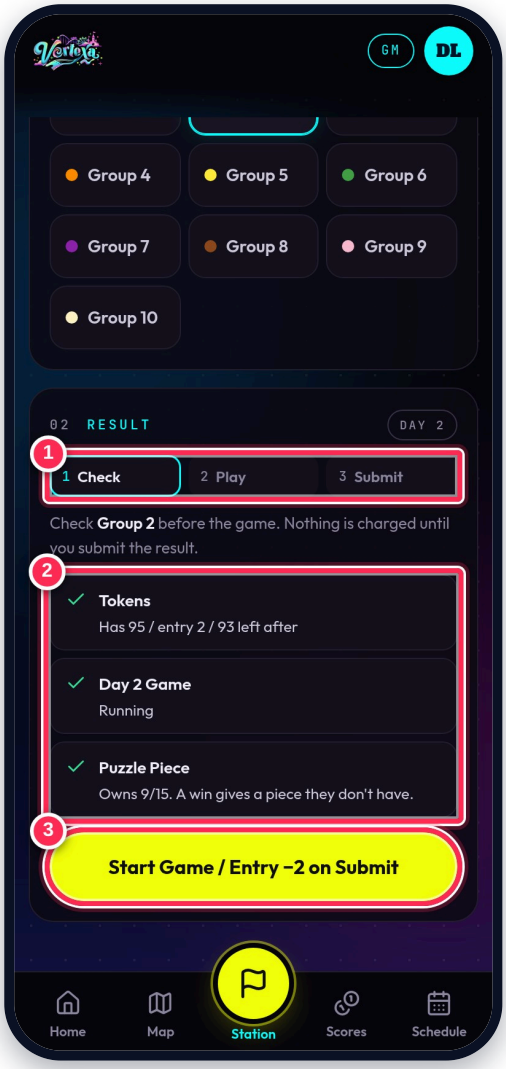
2 Play
Start the game

→

3 Submit
Success or Failed



01 Group: pick one group



02 Result: the checks

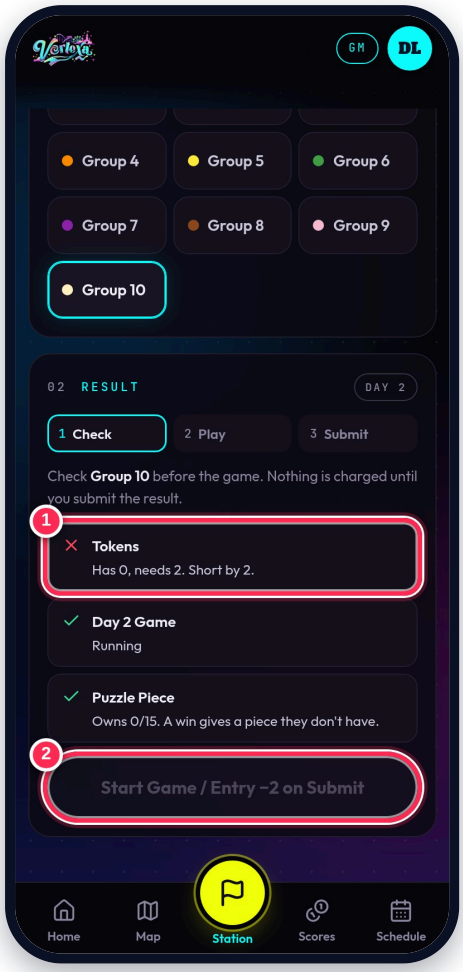
1. The **group buttons**. Tap the group at your station. On Day 2 you pick **one** group.
2. The group you picked.
3. Its **tokens** show at the top right.

1. The **step bar**. You are on step **1 Check**.
2. The **checks**. A green tick means fine.
3. **Start Game / Entry −2 on Submit**. It turns on only when no check is blocked.

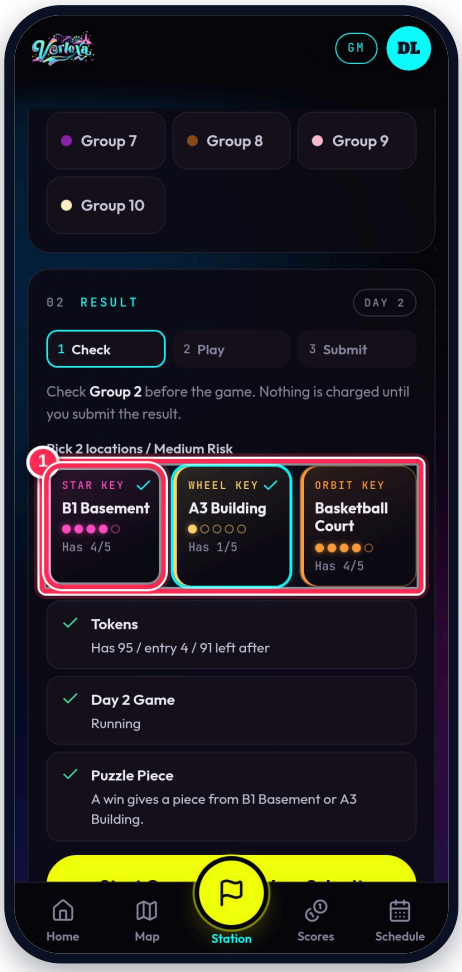
GOOD TO KNOW
Nothing is charged until you submit the result. The entry fee is shown on the button.

3.2 Day 2 Games: Checks and Risk Levels

If a check has a red cross, the game cannot start. Read the line, it tells you why.



A blocked check: not enough tokens



Medium and High risk stations: pick locations

1. **Tokens**: *Has 0, needs 2. Short by 2.* The group cannot pay the entry fee.
2. **Start Game** stays grey. Pick another group or tell this group.

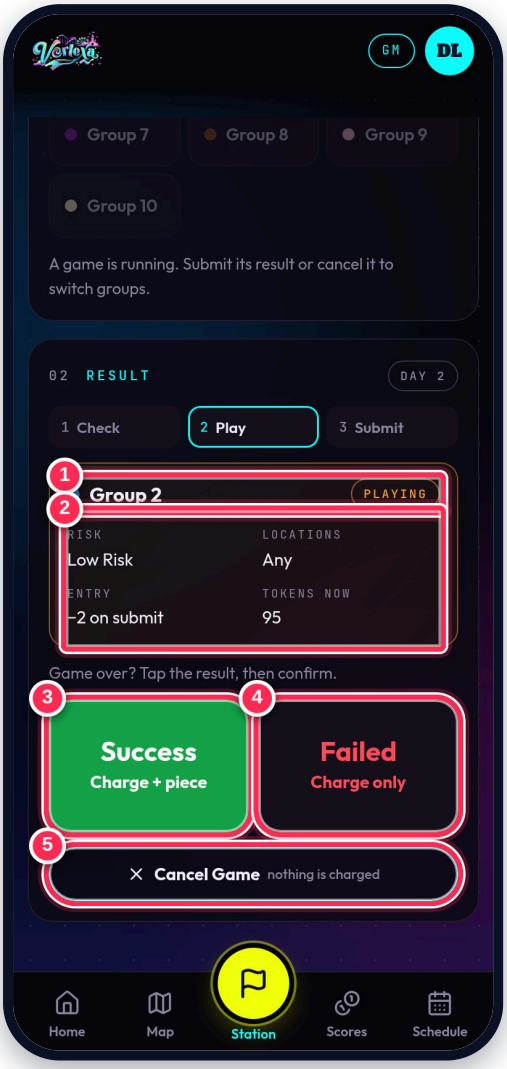
1. **Pick the locations**. Medium Risk: pick **2**. High Risk: pick **1**. Each card shows how many of its 5 pieces the group has.

Low Risk	No picking. A win gives a random piece from any location.
Medium Risk	Pick 2. A win gives a random piece from them.
High Risk	Pick 1. A win gives a piece of that location.

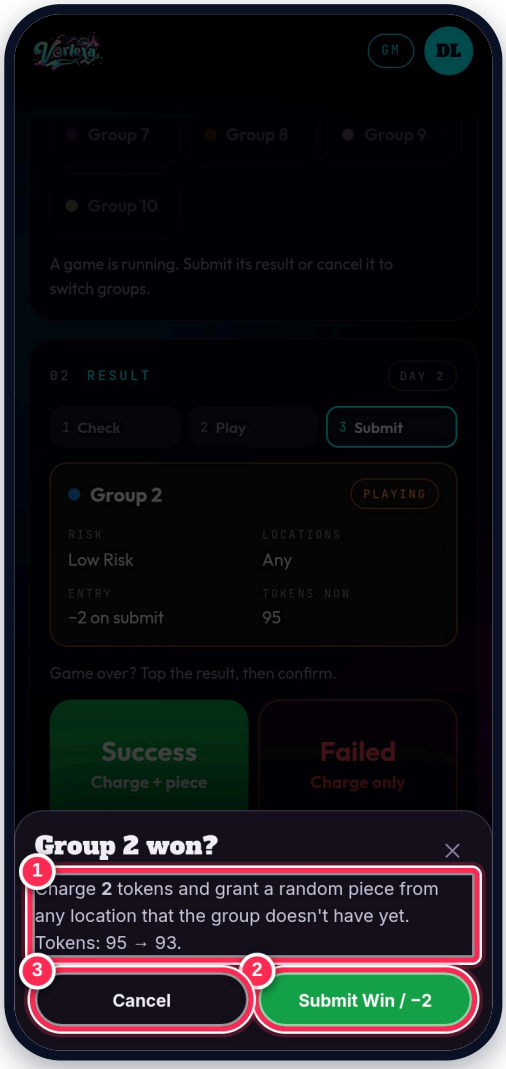
- **Green tick:** fine.
- **Red cross:** blocked. You cannot start.
- **Amber note:** you may start, but read it (for example a full location).
- **Grey dot:** still checking, or waiting for your pick.

3.2 Day 2 Games: Play and Submit

Tap **Start Game**. The group is now locked in and playing. When the challenge is over, submit the result.



Step 2: Play



Step 3: Submit

1. **Playing**: the group at your station. Other groups are greyed out until you finish.
2. The game facts: **Risk**, **Locations**, **Entry** and the group's **Tokens Now**.
3. **Success**: the group completed the challenge. Charges the entry fee **and** gives a puzzle piece.
4. **Failed**: charges the entry fee only.
5. **Cancel Game**: the group did not play. **Nothing is charged.**

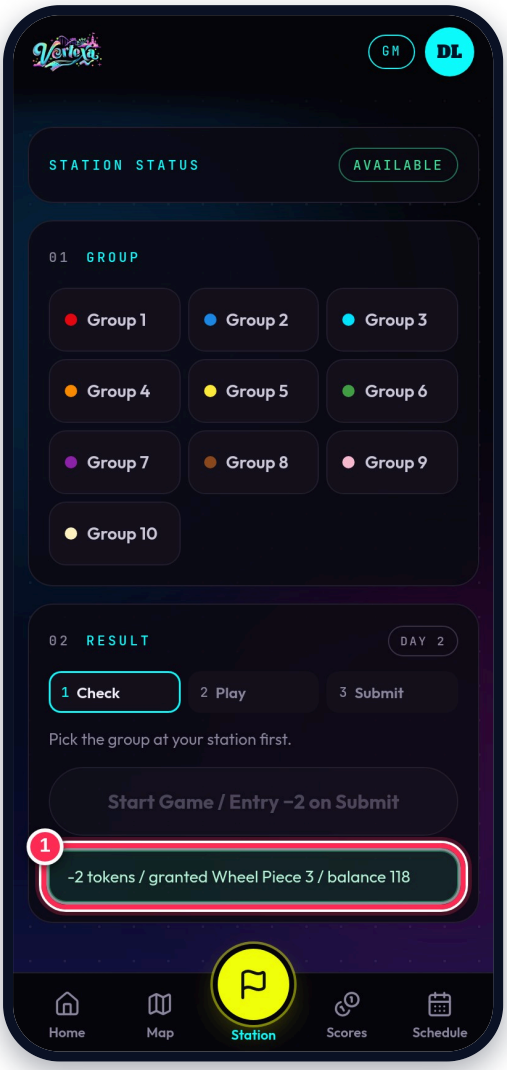
1. Read the sheet: the group, the fee and its tokens before and after.
2. **Submit Win** (or **Submit Loss**) sends it. A win gives a random piece the group does not have yet.
3. **Cancel** goes back so you can pick the other result.

IMPORTANT

The entry fee is charged on submit, **win or lose**. Confirm the result before you tap the button.

3.2 Day 2 Games: After Submitting

Read the message, then you are ready for the next group.

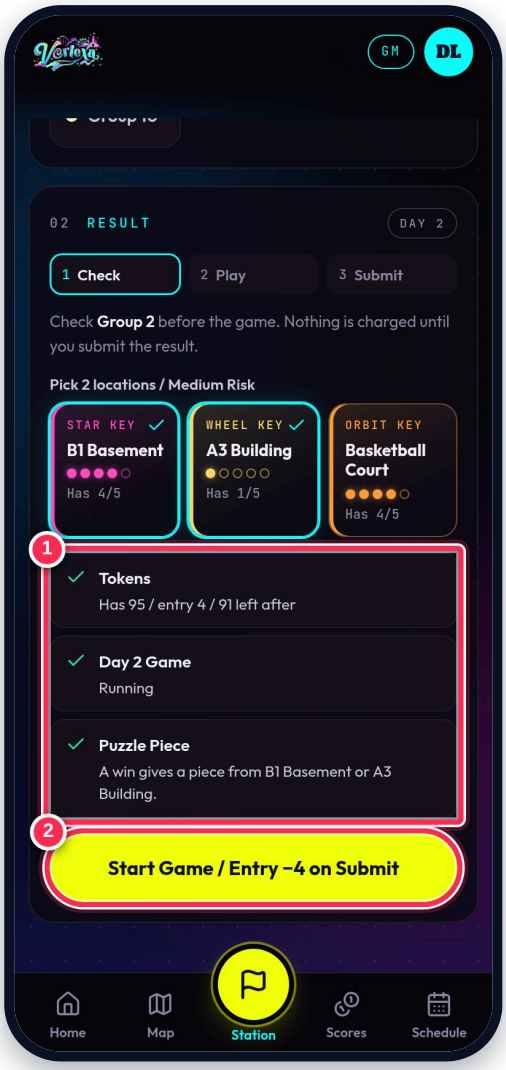


After Submit

1. The green message shows the tokens charged, the piece given and the new balance, for example *-2 tokens / granted Wheel Piece 3 / balance 118*. A lost game says *challenge lost* and shows no piece.

GOOD TO KNOW

Your station goes back to **Available** and the group is checked out. The group buttons turn on again.



A medium risk game, ready to start

1. With the locations picked, the **Puzzle Piece** check says which pieces a win can give.
2. **Start Game / Entry −4 on Submit**: the fee for this station is on the button.

TIP

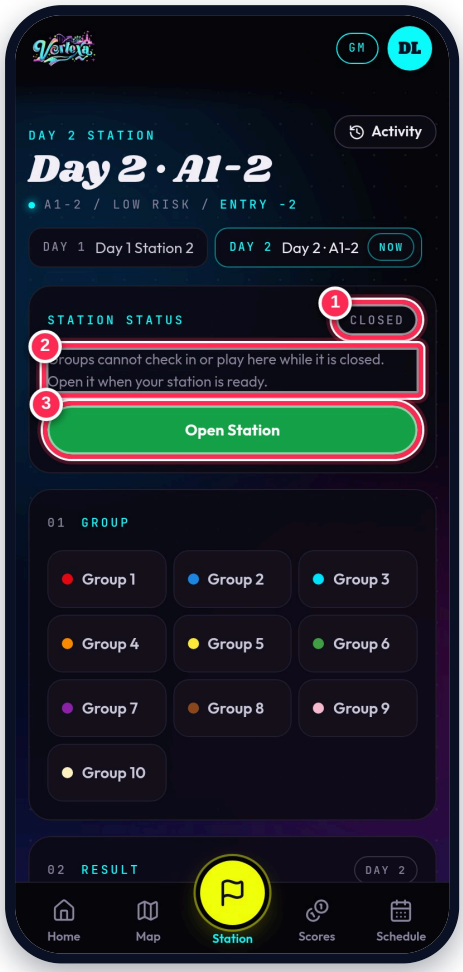
If a location is already **full (5/5)**, a win there gives nothing. The website tells you in the check.

IMPORTANT

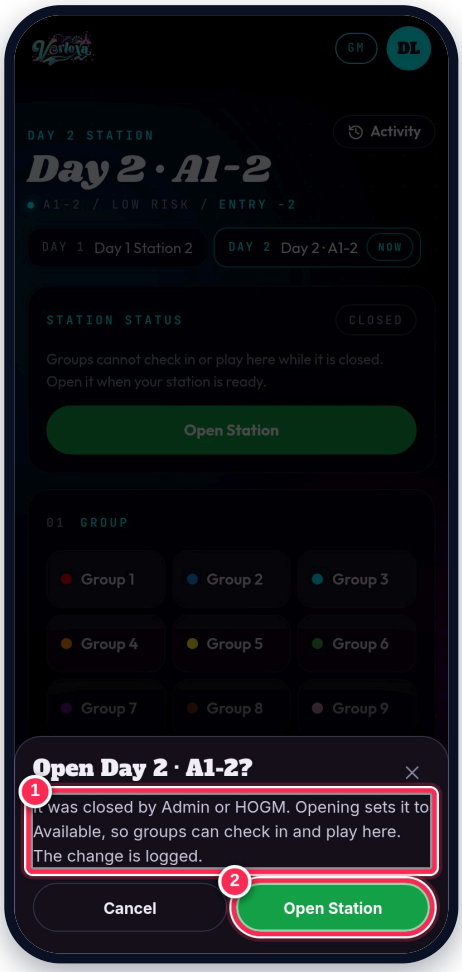
A game you started is saved **on this phone**. If the page reloads or the phone locks, open the Station Panel again **on the same phone** and the game is still there. Do not switch phones in the middle of a game.

3.4 Station Status

The status tells everyone, on every map, whether groups can play at your station.



Your station is Closed



Open your station?

1. **Closed**: groups cannot check in or play here.
2. The text explains who closed it: Admin or HOGM.
3. **Open Station**: tap when your station is ready.

1. Read the message. Opening sets the station to **Available**. The change is logged.
2. Tap **Open Station** to confirm.

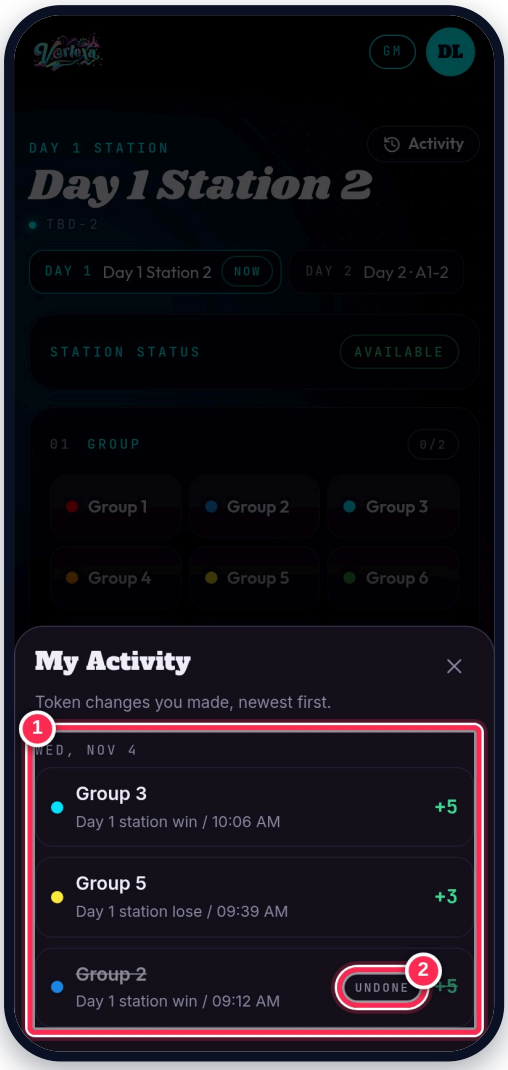
> **TIP**
> You never set the status by hand, except **Open Station**. **Start Game** sets In Progress. **Submit** or **Cancel** sets Available.

The Three Statuses

Available	Ready for a group.
In Progress	A game is running. Set by **Start Game**.
Closed	Not open. Only you, HOGM or Admin can open it again.

3.5 My Activity and Offline Mode

Check what you gave, and know what to do when the signal drops.



My Activity

1. Tap **Activity** at the top right of the Station Panel. The list shows the token changes **you** made, newest first, under their date.
2. A change you reversed is marked **Undone**.

If the Signal Drops

You can still submit results. The website keeps them and sends them when the connection comes back.

1. A message **Offline Queue Active** shows how many submissions are waiting.
2. **Keep the page open** until it clears. Do not close the tab.
3. If the server refuses one after you reconnect, a red message says **queued submission rejected**. It was **not applied**. Redo it by hand if it is still needed, then tap **Dismiss**.

> **IMPORTANT**
> Do not submit the same result twice because the screen is slow. The website protects against double charges, but wait for the message first.

4.1 Scores

See how every group is doing. Open it with the **Scores** tab. You can only look.



Scores

1. The columns: **Group**, **Tokens** and **Puzzles** (pieces out of 15).
2. Tap a **group row** to open it, tap again to close it.
3. The three keys. Each shows how many of its **5 pieces** the group has. **Full Set** means that key is complete.

GOOD TO KNOW

You see **how many** pieces a group has, not **which** pieces. Only the numbers are shared with Game Masters.

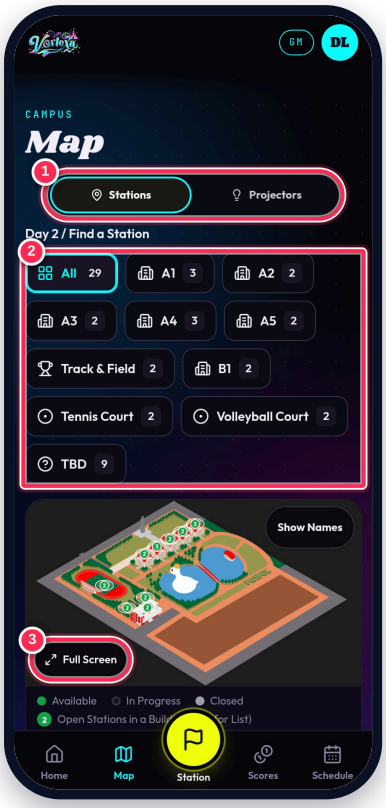
TIP

Use Scores to tell a group how far it is from a full set before a High Risk game. A key shown as **Lit** was already lit by that group.

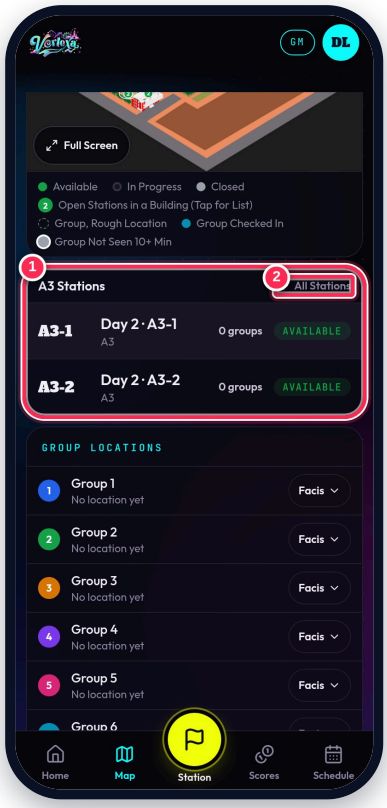
The scores update on their own. If a number looks old, switch to another tab and back.

5.1 The Map

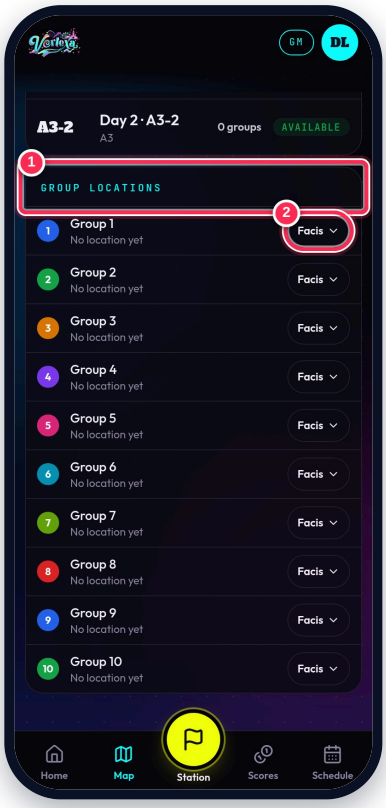
See every station and its status, and where each group is. Open it with the **Map** tab.



Map



Map / Stations



Map / Group Locations

1. **Stations / Projectors**. Switch what the map and list show.
2. **Building chips**. Tap a building (A1, A3, B1 ...) to see its stations.
3. **Full Screen** opens the 3D map in full screen.

1. **Station list** for the building you chose. Each row shows the station, how many groups are there and its status: *Available*, *In Progress* or *Closed*.
2. **All Stations** clears the building filter.

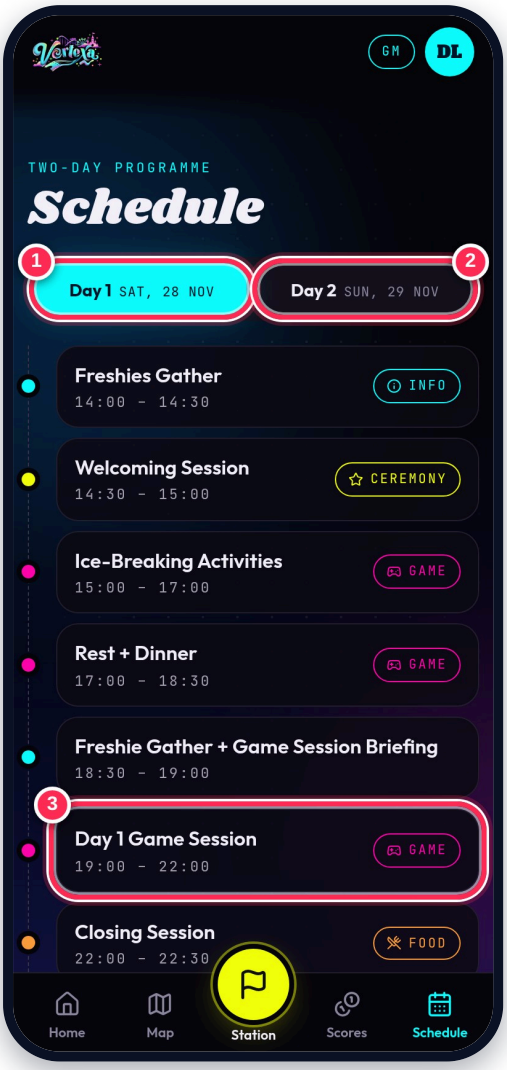
1. **Group Locations**. Every group is listed with where it was last seen.
2. **Facis** shows the names of the Facilitators in that group.

GOOD TO KNOW

The map shows which group is playing at a station because **Start Game** checks the group in. If a station looks wrong, tell HOGM or Admin.

6.1 Schedule

The programme for both days. Open it with the **Schedule** tab.



Schedule

1. **Day 1** (Sat, 28 Nov). Tap to show it.
2. **Day 2** (Sun, 29 Nov). Tap to switch.
3. **One programme item**: its name, time and a label. Game sessions are marked **Game**.

The Labels

INFO	A notice or a gathering.
CEREMONY	A ceremony or a session on stage.
GAME	A game session. Be at your station.
FOOD	A meal or a rest.

TIP

Your own crew timeline is the **Action Plan** on Home (2.1). The Schedule is what the Freshies see.

GOOD TO KNOW

A game only runs when Admin **starts the phase** in Live control. If a Game session has started on the schedule but the website says *No game running*, ask them.

7.1 Fixing Problems

WHAT YOU SEE ON SCREEN	WHY IT HAPPENS, AND WHAT TO DO
The Station Panel title says **No Station Yet** and the line under it says *Ask Admin to assign your station*.	Admin has not given you a station, so you cannot run games. Tell Admin.
The station marked **NOW** is for the wrong day.	The panel follows the game phases Admin starts in Live control, not the calendar. When Admin starts the next day's phase, **NOW** moves by itself. If it has not moved, ask Admin whether that phase has started.
(Day 2) The **Start Game** button is grey and does nothing.	A check above the button has a red cross. Read that line: it says exactly what is wrong. When every check is green or amber, the button turns on.
A check says **Tokens**: *Has 0, needs 2. Short by 2*.	The group cannot pay the entry fee. Do not start the game. Tell the group, or pick another group.
A check says **Day 2 Game**: *Not started yet*.	Admin has not started Day 2 in Live control. Wait. The check turns green by itself, with no reload.
A check says **Station Game**: *Switched off by Admin*.	Admin has paused station games for now. Wait until Admin switches them back on.
A check says **Token Freeze**.	Admin has frozen all tokens for now, so no result can be saved. Wait until Admin unfreezes them.
A check says **Station**: *Closed*.	Your station is closed, so groups cannot play. Tap **Open Station** (3.4).
An amber note says **Station**: *Shows In Progress*.	The website thinks a game is still running at your station. If nobody is playing, you can still start. If an earlier group was left behind, ask HOGM or Admin to clear it.
A check says **Puzzle Piece**: *is full*.	The group already has all 5 pieces of that location, so a win there gives nothing. On a Medium station the website uses the other location. On a High station, pick a different location.
A red message appears after you tap Submit.	The server refused the result and **nothing was charged**. Read the message, fix the cause (for example not enough tokens), then submit again, or tap **Cancel Game**.
A message says **Offline Queue Active**.	Your phone has no signal, so your submissions are waiting. Keep this page open. They send by themselves when the signal returns.
A red message says **queued submission rejected**.	A result you submitted offline was refused when the signal came back, so it was **not applied**. Redo it by hand if it is still needed, then tap **Dismiss** (3.5).
You gave the wrong result.	On Day 1, tap **Undo My Last Transaction** within the time limit (3.1). After that, or on Day 2, tell Admin straight away.
The game you started is gone after the page reloaded.	A running game is saved on the phone that started it. Open the Station Panel again on the **same phone and the same browser**.
A note says *The map could not show the group here*.	It only means the map could not mark the group at your station. The game and the tokens are fine. Carry on.

GOOD TO KNOW

Still stuck? Ask your **Head of Game Masters (HOGM)** or Admin. Tell them what the screen says.

7.2 Dos and Don'ts

Do

- Check you are on the station marked **NOW** before the games start.
- Pick the right **group** and read the confirm sheet before you submit.
- Wait for the green message after every submit. It is your proof that the tokens or the piece were given.
- Keep the Station Panel open on **one** phone at your station.
- Charge your phone. Bring a power bank.
- Tell Admin early if something looks wrong, such as a missing station or a wrong token balance. Small problems are easy to fix early.

Don't

- Don't tap **Start Game** for a group that has not arrived.
- Don't change phones in the middle of a game.
- Don't tap Submit twice because the screen is slow.
- Don't promise tokens or pieces outside the website. Only what you submit counts.
- Don't share your login.
- Don't forget to **Log Out** if you used someone else's phone.

What Game Masters Can and Cannot Do

YOU CAN	YOU CANNOT
Run games at your own station and give Day 1 rewards	Choose the reward or entry amounts (Admin sets them)
Charge a Day 2 entry fee and give a piece on a win	Give tokens or pieces outside a game
Open your own station when it is Closed	Run another Game Master's station
Undo your own last Day 1 reward in time	Start or stop game phases, or change the schedule
See scores, the map and the schedule	See *which* pieces a group owns (only how many)

Quick Reference

Keep this page on your phone or print it.

I WANT TO	GO TO	TAP
Run a Day 1 game	Station	**Group** (1 or 2), **Start Game**, **Win** / **Participation**, **Submit Result**, **Give Tokens**
Run a Day 2 game	Station	**Group**, read the checks, **Start Game**, **Success** / **Failed**, **Submit**
Stop a game that did not happen	Station	**Cancel Game**
Fix a wrong Day 1 reward	Station	**Undo My Last Transaction**
Open my closed station	Station	**Open Station**
See what I gave	Station	**Activity**
See every group's tokens and pieces	Scores	A **group row**
See a station's status	Map	A **building chip**
See where groups are	Map	Scroll to **Group Locations**
Check the programme	Schedule	**Day 1** or **Day 2**
Open my crew timeline	Home	**Action Plan**, then the day
Sign out	Profile button	**Log Out**

Every Game Right Group → Play → Right Result → Wait for the Message